WISCONSIN
UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN–MADISON

October 16, 2026
Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am applying for the Assistant Professor position in the Electrical and Computer Engineering at the University of Toronto. I am a PhD Candidate in Computer Science, School of Computing and Artificial Intelligence at the University of Wisconsin–Madison. I am advised by Dr. Rahul Chatterjee, writing the final chapter of my thesis, and expected to graduate by Summer 2027.

My research examines **how interpersonal and structural technologies enables online and offline gender-based violence (GBV) such as intimate partner violence, labor/sex trafficking, genocide, and environmental destruction**. Specifically, how **equitable design interventions (trainings, tools, and advocacy practices) can reduce harm and help marginalized communities foster collective safety, healing, resistance, and liberation**. To do this, I combine ethnographic, participatory, and design research methods to bridge disciplinary boundaries in and beyond Human-Computer Interaction, Security & Privacy, Psychology, Politics, Law, History, & Nursing. I have made contributions across two interwoven threads: (1) designing interventions to support interpersonal violence survivors, and (2) research and design framework to help communities liberate from structural violence. I have published 5 and 4 in-review papers at top-tier venues, such as CSCW (honorable mention top 5%), CHI (best paper top 1%), USENIX Security, CCS. I have also presented papers, panels, and workshops at policy, law, and healthcare venues like Wisconsin State Capitol, Cook County Human Trafficking Task Force, Socialism, Gayabii Gawiin, Women Are Sacred, Reclaiming Our Love, and Native Nations Nursing, Helpers, and Healers Summit. I have guest lectured at multiple iterations of UW–Madison courses who assigned my papers as course readings in Psychology: Sexual Violence Advocacy and in Social Work: Interpersonal Violence.

Embracing an *advocacy-researcher* practice, I direct the administration, fundraising, outreach, and survivor services at Madison Tech Clinic (MTC), a trauma-informed intervention that has supported 180+ survivors (40+ survivors personally) with their digital safety needs. I co-authored five grant proposals, one of which was awarded $750,000 from US Department of Justice to expand our services to 26 urban and rural GBV organizations across 32 counties of Wisconsin, US. I have trained over 200 health practitioners, criminal justice workers, and policymakers through nation-level (National Network of Ending Domestic Violence, National Indigenous Women's Resource Center, Lac Courte Oreilles Tribal Nation) and state-level coalitions (EndAbuseWI , The Network, Mending the Sacred Hoop). I have also been awarded the Morgridge Fellowship to recognize my community-engaged scholarship.

As a teacher, I strive to cultivate intellectual rigor and compassionate care among students. I will incorporate an interdisciplinary perspective while teaching courses on ethics, social justice, security & privacy, HCI, and research methods. I will setup a community-engaged research program by establishing a Tech Clinic in Toronto with GBV organizations in Ontario. To secure funding, I plan to submit grant applications with national agencies (NSERC, CIHR, MITACS, CIFAR, SSHRC), foundations (Ford, MILA, Open Society, John D. and Catherine T. MacArthur), and tech companies. I will build on U of T's existing strengths by bringing my interdisciplinary perspective to responsible AI that foregrounds ecology, violence, and sustainability. I envision collaborating with researchers such as Tanya Berger-Wolf, Christoph Becker, & Robert Soden (on AI, climate damage and preservation), Thomas Ristenpart, Ramona Alaggia (on GBV) in Identity, Privacy and Security Institute, Women and Gender Institute, Centre for Climate Science and Engineering, Indigenous Research Network, Centre for Indigenous Studies, Schwartz Reisman Institute for Technology and Society, Computational Social Science Lab, Data Sciences Institute, Citizen Lab.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,
Naman Gupta, PhD Candidate

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